

Australia

Australia is the world's largest island. Most of it is made of hot, dry desert called "the outback." In the hottest months, some of Australia's lakes may dry up completely. However, there are rain forests here, too, and many of the animals that live in Australia are found nowhere else.

Location

Australia lies south of the equator, between the Pacific and Indian oceans. Summer here is from December to February.



HABITAT KEY

- Temperate grasslands
- Tropical forests
- Scrublands
- Mountains
- Tropical grasslands
- Hot desert



Emu

Australia's largest bird is 5–6½ ft (1.5–2 m) tall and can weigh up to 132 lb (60 kg). Its call can be heard up to 1 mile (2 km) away!

This mouse-sized marsupial doesn't eat honey—just nectar and pollen.

Honey possum

Red kangaroo

Kangaroos are marsupials, which are a type of animal that carry their young in a pouch on their body. Red kangaroos are only found in Australia. They move by hopping around on their powerful back legs.



A baby kangaroo, called a joey, rides in its mother's pouch.

SCALE

0 250 miles
0 250 kilometers

The kookaburra is the largest kingfisher. Its call sounds like a laugh.

Blue-winged kookaburra

This lizard defends itself by opening its frill, standing on its hind legs, and hissing.



Frilled lizard

This desert lizard is covered in protective thorny scales.



Thorny devil

These huge caterpillars eat witchetty bush roots—and Australian Aboriginals, the first people to live here, eat them!



Witchetty grubs

Common off the Australian coast, the world's largest predatory fish has 300 teeth.



Great white shark

